UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION

Civil Services (Preliminary Exam) - 1993

GENERAL STUDIES : PAPER-I

Time: 2 hours **Maximum Number: 200**

ANCIENT HISTORY

1. The term nishka, which meant an ornament in the Vedic period, was used in later times to denote a/an:

(a) Weapon
(b) Agricultural implement
(c) Script
(d) Coin

Ans. (d) : During the Vedic Period, the term 'nishka' was used for an ornament. But in later time it was referred to denote gold coins of the Mauryans. Nishka is also referred as the world's oldest currency coins. The unit value of goods was a gold bar called 'nishka' weighing three hundred and twenty ratis.

2. The Buddhist sect Mahayana formally came into existence during the reign of:

(a) Ajatashatru (b) Ashoka
(c) Dharmapala (d) Kanishka

Ans. (d) : During the reign of Kanishka, the fourth Buddhist council was held at Kundalvana in Kashmir in 1st century to settle the dispute among the various sects of Buddhist. The council was headed by Vasumitra and Ashvaghosha. After the end of council Buddhism was divided into two major sects named as Hinayana and Mahayana.

Mahayana sects considered Buddha as God. This sect was in favour of idol worship. Sanskrit language was used for preaching and teaching.

Hinayana sects considered themselves as original or old form of Buddhism followers. They considered Buddha as a pious man and were against of idol worship. They use Pali language for Preaching.

3. In Jainism 'perfect knowledge' is referred to as:

(a) Jina (b) Ratna
(c) Kaivalya (d) Nirvana

Ans. (c) : The 24th Tirthanakara and real founder of Jainism, Mahavir Swami get enlightenment at the age of 42 under sal tree on the banks of the river Rijupalika. He did rigorous penance for 12 years in the jungle in the search of Kaivalya or enlightenment. In Jainism Kaivalya is also referred to as perfect knowledge.

The three jewels or Triratna of Jainism include Right Faith, Right Knowledge and Right Conduct.

Jainism does not condemn the Varna System and is considered as a religion of self-half. There are no gods or spiritual beings that will help human beings.

4. The last in the succession of Jaina Tirthankaras was:

(a) Parsvanatha (b) Rishabha
(c) Mahavira (d) Manisubrata

Ans. (c) : The 24th and the last Tirthankara of Jainism was Mahavir Swami. In Jainism, a Tirthankara is a saviour and spiritual teacher of the dharma. The first tirthankara was Rishabhanath, who is credited for formulating and organising humans to live in a society harmoniously.

Mahavira, also known as Vardhamana was born in the early part of the 6th century BCE into a Royal family in Kundagram, Vaishali district, Bihar.

5. Ashokan inscriptions were first deciphered by:

(a) Buhler (b) Robert Sewell
(c) James Prinsep (d) Codplngton

Ans. (c) : James Prinsep was a European scholar who deciphered the edicts of the Ashoka.

Ashoka inscription were written in Magadhi, Prakrit using the Brahmi script and Kharosthi script. The inscription and edicts of Ashoka refer to a collection of 33 inscriptions of the pillars of Ashoka, as well as boulders and cave walls. These were made by Emperor Ashoka during his reign from 272 to 231 BC.

6. Chanakya, was also known as:

(a) Bhattasvamin (b) Rajasekhara
(c) Vishnugupta (d) Vishakhadatta

Ans. (c) : Chanakya who is also known as Kautilya or Vishnugupta was an ancient Indian teacher a great philosopher and a great economist. He helped Chandragupta Maurya to establish Mauryan Empire.

Chanakya wrote two books, Arthashastra and Chanakya Niti. Arthashastra dealt with monetary and fiscal policies, welfare, international relation and war strategies in detail.

As such he is considered the pioneer of the field of political science and economics in India.

7. The earliest rock-cut caves in western India are those at:

(a) Nasik, Ellora and Ajanta
(b) Junnar, Kalyan and Pitalkhora
(c) Ajanta, Bhaja and Kondane
(d) Bhala, Pitalkhora and Kondane

Ans. (c) : The earliest rock-cut caves in Western India are those at Ajanta, Bhaja and Kondane.

Ajanta caves are 30 rock-cut Buddhist cave monuments in Aurangabad district of Maharashtra, India.

The cave also present painting depicting the past lives and rebirth of the Buddha, pictorial tales from Aryasura's Jatakmala and rock cut sculptures of Buddhist deities.

8. Among the four works mentioned below which one is encyclopedic in nature?

(a) Amarakosha (b) Siddhanta Shiromani
(c) Brihat-Samhita (d) Ashtangahrdaya

Ans. (c) : Brihat Samhita of Varahamihira is an encylopedia of a astrological and other subjects of human interest including astronomy, planetary movement, eclipses, rainfall, clouds, manufacture of perfume, matrimony and domestic relations.

9. Who among the following is NOT associated with medicine in India?

(a) Dhanvantari (b) Bhaskaracharya
(c) Charaka (d) Susruta

Ans. (b) : Bhaskaracharya was born in 1114 CE in the Sahyadhri Mountain range, near the town of Patan in Maharashtra. He was an Indian mathematician and astronomer. His notable work is Siddhanta Shiromani. Dhanvantri, Charaka and Susruta were associated with Medicine in India.

Charaka is usually known as the father of Indian medicine. He wrote Charak Samhita. Susruta wrote Sushruta Samhita.

10. Consider the following passage:

"In the course of a career on the road spanning almost thirty years, he crossed the breadth of the Eastern hemisphere, visited territories equivalent to about 44 modern countries, and put behind him a total distance of approximately 73,000 miles." The world's greatest traveller of pre-modern times to whom the above passage refers is:

(a) Megasthenes (b) Fa-hien
(c) Marco Polo (d) Ibn Battuta

Ans. (d) : Ibn Battuta (also called Islamic Marco Polo) was a Moroccan scholar and explorer who travelled extensively in Africa and Eurasia. He travelled more than any other explorer in Pre-modern history totaling around 73,000 miles in his 30 years travelling journey. He came to India in reign of Muhammad Bin Tughluq. He wrote a famous book named Rihlah.

11. A lot of details, regarding the village administration under the Cholas is provided by the Inscriptions at

(a) Thanjavur (b) Uraiyur
(c) Kanchipuram (d) Uttaramerur

Ans. (d) : A tenth century inscription on a temple wall of the brahman village of Uttaramerur gives the details of village administration under Cholas. The Chola Village system was very well enveloped and systematic. The assemblies of the villages of chola inscription describe assemblies as the "**Ur**" and "**Sabha**".

Ur refers to village and **Nadu** refers to district in Chola empire. The Sabha was an important unit of administration during the rule of the Chola empire. It was an assembly of members which consisted of rich Brahmin landowners. The function of the Sabha was to collect revenues, enforce justice and to manage the lands that were being gifted to the Brahmins. The village assemblies looked after the maintenance of peace, tanks, roads, public ponds revenue collection, judiciary, education and temples. The village assemblies were in charge of the payment of taxes due from the villages to the treasury.

12 . Which one of the following is considered to be the world's greatest iconographical creations made by the sthapatis of south India, particularly during the Chola period?

(a) Mahishasura mardini (b) Nataraja
(c) Rama (d) Somaskanda

Ans. (b) : Nataraja is considered to be the world's greatest iconographical creations made by the sthapatis of south India, particularly during the Chola period.

The Chola Empire was founded by Vijayalaya. He took over the Tanjore kingdom in the 8th century and led to the rise of the mighty Cholas by defeating the Pallavas. Tanjore was hence made the first capital of the eminent Chola Empire.

13. Which one of the following pairs of kings of ancient and medieval periods of Indian history and the works authored by them is correctly matched?

(a) Krishnadevaraya : Samarangana sutradhara
(b) Mahendravarman : Mattavilasa prahasana
(c) Mahendravarman : Mattavilasaprahasana
(d) Somesvara : Amuktamalyada

Ans. (b) : The Pallavas reached their zenith during the reign of Mahendravarman I (CE 600–630), a contemporary of Harsha and Pulakeshin II. Among the sources of the period, Xuanzang's account serves as a link, as he traveled through the domains of all three kings. Mahendravarman was a writer and artist of some distinction. The play associated with him, Mattavilasa prahasana, treats in a farcical manner the idiosyncrasies of Buddhist and Shaiva ascetics.